



CONNECTICUT
Children & Families

Coordinating Supports for Families 8/6/26

Ken Mysogland LCSW
Chief Administrator of External Affairs
CT DCF

Connecticut's Statutory Authority

Child Protection

Children's Behavioral Health

Prevention

CT Department of Children and Families

Embracing the wisdom of families with lived expertise

Our Vision

CT's Children are safe & sound within loving and supportive families.



“Prevention” – What Does That Mean?

“Prevention” – What are we Preventing?

- Going Deeper Into an Existing System such as Education, Juvenile, Justice or Behavioral Health?
- Ultimately Preventing Involvement with CPS?
- “Prevention” – What Is the Impact of the Term On Those We Serve?
- “Less Surveillance and More Support”
- “Family Strengthening” is Empowering



5 Pathways of Support– Which Do You Choose?

- 211ct.org or Dial 211
- CTBHP.com
- ConnectingtoCareCt.org
- Carelonbh.com or [877-381-4193](tel:877-381-4193) (option 1)
- WeAreCt.org



Community Pathways

Supports for Connecticut families

Community Pathways is a unique, strengths-based program serving all Connecticut families and their children under age 18 in order to:

- Empower families to be their own best advocates.
- Help families navigate the Connecticut children's behavioral health system of care.
- Provide family-centered support.

By dialing **877-381-4193 (option 1)**, callers can speak to a specialist to discuss supports and get connected to resources.

Accepting referrals from families and community partners, we provide **information, access, and connection** to needed community-based supports and evidence-based interventions.



Supports across Connecticut can be found here

Contact Carelon Behavioral Health's Community Pathways program at 877-381-4193 (option 1) during regular business hours for:

- In-home services to help with a mental health or substance use problem for parents and youth under 18.
- Non-emergency behavioral health needs.
- In-home, evidence-based interventions.

Dial 2-1-1 for:

- 24/7 emergency mobile crisis support.
- Connection to social drivers of health needs such as housing, income, childcare, legal assistance, and other social services.

Call the Department of Children and Families 24/7 Careline at 800-842-2288 to:

- Connect to Voluntary Care Management services.
- Report child maltreatment, abuse, or neglect.



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Community Pathways

- “Community Pathways is a unique, **strength-based** program serving all Connecticut families...”
- “**Empower** families to be their own best **advocates.**”
- “Provide **family centered support.**”



Words Matter

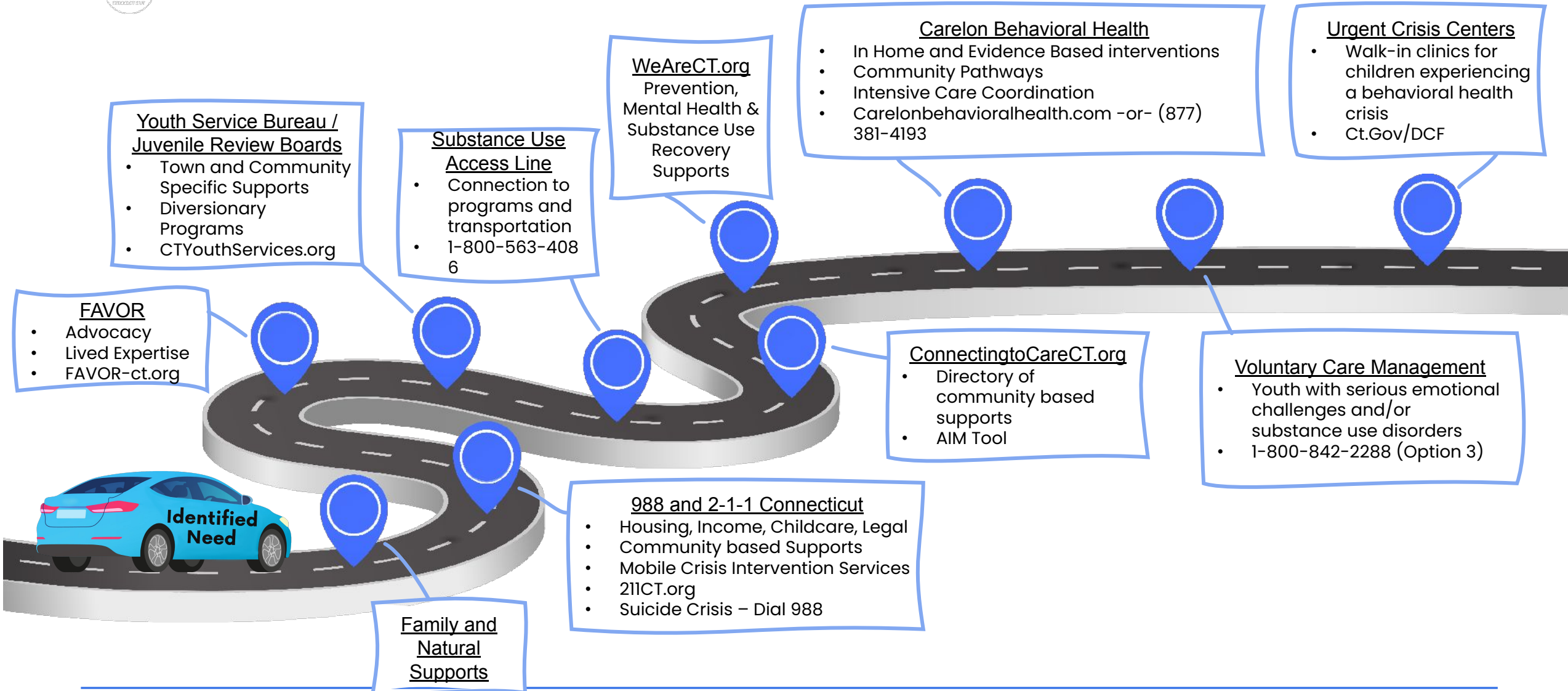
- “We Need to Lift the Stigma Associated with Asking for Help”
- “Supporting and Empowering families”
- “Children are Best Supported in Families and Families are Best Supported in the Community.”



Mandated Reporters

- Legislative Change
- Seeking Support is a Sign of Strength
- Response to Non-Accepts

Seeking Support is a Sign of Strength



Promoting Narrative Change – Media Partners

“This is a clear reminder for all members of our community – professionals, family members, and concerned citizens, – that protecting children takes our collective efforts.

Community-based supports are available throughout Connecticut and can be located by dialing **211**, visiting [**WeAreCt.Org**](http://WeAreCt.Org) or [**ConnectingToCareCT.org**](http://ConnectingToCareCT.org) and by calling the **Substance Use Access line** at [**1-800-563-4086**](tel:1-800-563-4086). Individuals experiencing domestic violence can visit [**CTSafeConnect.org**](http://CTSafeConnect.org) or call or text [**\(888\) 774-2900**](tel:888-774-2900). Advocates are available 24/7 and all languages are supported.”

A reasonable suspicion of child maltreatment can be made to the Child Abuse and Neglect Careline by dialing [**1-800-842-2288**](tel:1-800-842-2288). The Careline is open 24 hours a day, 365 days a year. Callers to the Careline can remain anonymous.”



Braided and Blended Funding

Approximately 22% of the State budget goes to support children and families upstream to prevent them from going deeper into an existing system including involvement with DCF.

Combination of:

- State
- Federal
- Medicaid



Thoughts and Questions?

